MODULE 4

Stories on Stage

"The play is not in the words.
It's behind the words."

— STELLA ADLER

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

In what ways might a play be an effective way to tell a story?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**The Saga of Pecos Bill** · Anthony D. Fredericks	PLAY · TALL TALE
2	**The Traveling Trio: Cesky Krumlov, Czech Republic**	MEDIA · VIDEO
3	**Gigi and the Wishing Ring** · Italian Fairy Tale	PLAY · CLASSIC TALE
4	**Two Bear Cubs** · Robert D. San Souci	PLAY · MYTH

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NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 4 · Stories on Stage · Grade 3 · 25 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

audition

When actors go to an **audition**, they —

- ◯ **A.** sell tickets at the door.
- ◯ **B.** give a short performance to show what they can do.
- ◯ **C.** sweep the stage after the show.
- ◯ **D.** watch a play from their seats.

Q2 L.3.6

rehearse

If you **rehearse** a play, you —

- ◯ **A.** practice it many times so that you are prepared.
- ◯ **B.** forget all of your lines.
- ◯ **C.** build the set out of wood.
- ◯ **D.** paint pictures of the actors.

Q3 L.3.6

ability

If you have the **ability** to do something, you —

- ◯ **A.** are too tired to begin.
- ◯ **B.** have asked someone else to do it.
- ◯ **C.** can do it because you know how.
- ◯ **D.** will do it tomorrow instead.

Q4 L.3.6

actor

An **actor** is a person who —

- ◯ **A.** acts in plays, movies, or other performances.
- ◯ **B.** sells popcorn in the lobby.
- ◯ **C.** writes a review in the newspaper.
- ◯ **D.** takes the tickets at the door.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE SAGA OF PECOS BILL

Q5 L.3.5 TRAP

genuine

Baby Bill found a **genuine** grizzly bear. Something **genuine** is —

- ◯ **A.** kind and gentle to others.
- ◯ **B.** very large in size.
- ◯ **C.** real and not pretend.
- ◯ **D.** brand new from a store.

Q6 L.3.4

saga

The narrators tell the **saga** of Pecos Bill. A **saga** is —

- ◯ **A.** a short list of rules.
- ◯ **B.** a long, detailed story about heroic events.
- ◯ **C.** a song sung at the end of a play.
- ◯ **D.** a map of the state of Texas.

Q7 L.3.4

coiled

Bill **coiled** the long snake like a rope. If you **coiled** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** cut it into small pieces.
- ◯ **B.** threw it far away.
- ◯ **C.** washed it in the river.
- ◯ **D.** shaped it into loops or rings.

Q8 L.3.4

whirled

Bill **whirled** the snake around and around his head. When you have **whirled** something, you —

- **A.** spun it quickly in circles.
- **B.** set it down gently.
- **C.** hid it under a rock.
- **D.** counted it slowly.

Q9 L.3.5 TRAP

tame

Bill decided to **tame** the wild tornado. To **tame** something is to —

- **A.** a soft animal kept as a pet.
- **B.** run away from it as fast as you can.
- **C.** make something wild become calm and under control.
- **D.** make a loud, frightening noise.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE TRAVELING TRIO: CESKY KRUMLOV

Q10 L.3.4

Baroque

The children visit a **Baroque** theater. Buildings from the **Baroque** period were —

- **A.** from many years ago, very fancy and decorated.
- **B.** small and plain.
- **C.** built only last year.
- **D.** made entirely of glass.

Q11 L.3.4

pulleys

Stagehands worked **pulleys** under the stage. **Pulleys** are —

- **A.** painted curtains at the back of a stage.
- **B.** wheels wrapped with rope that people use to lift heavy objects.
- **C.** seats where the audience sits.
- **D.** doors in the floor of the stage.

Q12 L.3.4

backdrop

On a stage, a **backdrop** is —

- **A.** a rope used to lift the curtain.
- **B.** the front row of seats.
- **C.** a machine that makes thunder sounds.
- **D.** a painted curtain or wall that shows the setting of the scene.

Q13 L.3.4

performance

If you sing, dance, or speak in front of a group, you give a **performance**. A **performance** is —

- **A.** a show that you present in front of an audience.
- **B.** a ticket you buy to get inside.
- **C.** a quiet room behind the stage.
- **D.** a list of the actors' names.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · GIGI AND THE WISHING RING

Q14 L.3.4

eminent

Maliarda is the daughter of an **eminent** lord. An **eminent** person is —

- **A.** tired and sleepy.
- **B.** poor and unknown.
- **C.** famous and important.
- **D.** young and small.

Q15 L.3.4

peasant

Gigi says a fine lady will not look at a **peasant** like him. A **peasant** is —

- **A.** someone who is very poor and may work as a farmer.
- **B.** a king who rules a country.
- **C.** a soldier who guards a castle.
- **D.** a wealthy merchant in the city.

Q16 L.3.4

stately

Maliarda asks if the **stately** home is Gigi's. When something is **stately**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** tiny and crowded.
- ◯ **B.** old and broken down.
- ◯ **C.** awesome or grand.
- ◯ **D.** dark and scary.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · GIGI AND THE WISHING RING (CONTINUED)

Q17 L.3.5 TRAP

deceive

Maliarda asks if Gigi thinks he can **deceive** her. If you **deceive** others, you —

- ◯ **A.** decide which one of them is right.
- ◯ **B.** tell a lie or try to make them believe something untrue.
- ◯ **C.** help them carry something heavy.
- ◯ **D.** leave the room without a word.

Q18 L.3.4

superior

Maliarda calls herself the **superior** player. Someone who is **superior** at something is —

- ◯ **A.** the very last to finish.
- ◯ **B.** too shy to take part.
- ◯ **C.** sitting high above the stage.
- ◯ **D.** more skilled than others.

Q19 L.3.4

merciful

Gigi chooses to be **merciful** to Maliarda. Someone who is **merciful** is —

- ◯ **A.** rich and powerful.
- ◯ **B.** kind and forgiving.
- ◯ **C.** quick and clever.
- ◯ **D.** loud and angry.

Q20 L.3.4

greedily

Older Brother ate the berries **greedily**. When you do something **greedily**, you —

- ◯ **A.** take more than you need.
- ◯ **B.** share it with everyone first.
- ◯ **C.** save it for another day.
- ◯ **D.** give it all away.

Q21 L.3.4

hesitation

After a moment's **hesitation**, Younger Brother followed. A **hesitation** is —

- ◯ **A.** a fast run down a hill.
- ◯ **B.** a loud cheer of joy.
- ◯ **C.** a long, deep sleep.
- ◯ **D.** a pause that shows you are unsure about doing something.

Q22 L.3.5 TRAP

burden

Mountain Lion set her **burden** down to help. A **burden** is —

- ◯ **A.** a small bird that lives in trees.
- ◯ **B.** something that is heavy to carry.
- ◯ **C.** a path that goes up a mountain.
- ◯ **D.** a warm place to rest.

Q23 L.3.4

unnoticed

Measuring Worm enters **unnoticed** by the others. When something is **unnoticed**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** very loud and easy to hear.
- ◯ **B.** placed high on a shelf.
- ◯ **C.** painted a bright color.
- ◯ **D.** not seen by anyone.

Q24 L.3.4

drowsy

The cubs were **drowsy** as they woke up. A **drowsy** person is —

- ◯ **A.** wide awake and full of energy.
- ◯ **B.** hungry and looking for food.
- ◯ **C.** sleepy and may not be able to think clearly.
- ◯ **D.** angry and ready to argue.

Q25 L.3.4

reassuring

Mother Deer was **reassuring** her worried friend. If you are **reassuring** a friend, you are —

- ◯ **A.** making them more afraid than before.
- ◯ **B.** asking them to leave you alone.
- ◯ **C.** measuring how tall they are.
- ◯ **D.** trying to keep them from worrying about something.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 4 · Stories on Stage · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.3.1 · RL.3.2 · RL.3.3 · RL.3.5 · RL.3.6 · RI.3.1 · RI.3.2 · RI.3.3

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · The Saga of Pecos Bill

PLAY · TALL TALE · ANTHONY D. FREDERICKS / CORY GADBEY · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.3.5

At the very beginning of the play, before the dialogue starts, the reader finds a list of characters and a staging note. What is the purpose of these features?

- ◯ **A.** To name who is in the play and tell how to set up the stage.
- ◯ **B.** To give the ending of the story away.
- ◯ **C.** To list the songs the actors will sing.
- ◯ **D.** To explain the rules of a game.

Q2 RL.3.3

How does Pecos Bill come to be raised by coyotes?

- ◯ **A.** His parents leave him with the coyotes on purpose.
- ◯ **B.** A cowboy carries him to the coyote den.
- ◯ **C.** He bounces out of the family wagon, crawls into a coyote den, and the mama coyote raises him.
- ◯ **D.** He is born in a cave full of coyotes.

Q3 RL.3.3

What does Cowboy 1 tell Pecos Bill that surprises him?

- ◯ **A.** That there is a drought in Texas.
- ◯ **B.** That Bill is not a coyote but a human being, because he has no tail.
- ◯ **C.** That a tornado is coming.
- ◯ **D.** That coyotes cannot swim.

Q4 RL.3.3

How does Pecos Bill make a rope to use as a cowboy?

- **A.** He buys one at the ranch.
- **B.** He braids it from his coyote fur.
- **C.** He pulls a vine from a tall tree.
- **D.** He whirls a rattlesnake around until it grows long and thin, then coils it like a rope.

Q5 RL.3.3

How does Bill solve the cowboys' problem of the long drought in Texas?

- **A.** He swings his snake lasso and ropes water from the Rio Grande River.
- **B.** He digs a deep well by hand.
- **C.** He waits for it to rain.
- **D.** He rides his mountain lion to another state.

Q6 RL.3.3

How does Bill decide to handle the biggest, meanest tornado that ever came into Texas?

- **A.** He hides from it in a cave.
- **B.** He ropes it with his snake.
- **C.** He rides it until it spins itself out.
- **D.** He sends the cowboys away to safety.

Q7 RL.3.6

Why did the author use FOUR narrators instead of just one to tell this play?

- **A.** Because one narrator forgot the lines.
- **B.** Because the play is about four cowboys.
- **C.** So the narrators could sing together.
- **D.** So their lines sound like a lively conversation, as if they are telling the story to the audience.

Q8 RL.3.2 TRAP

"The Saga of Pecos Bill" is a TALL TALE. Which detail BEST shows that it is a tall tale, not a true story?

- **A.** Bill helps the other cowboys on the ranch.
- **B.** Bill whirls a snake into a 30-foot rope and rides a tornado — things no real person could do.
- **C.** Bill's family travels west in a wagon.
- **D.** Texas is a very big state.

Selection 2 · The Traveling Trio: Cesky Krumlov, Czech Republic

MEDIA: INFORMATIONAL VIDEO · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.3.2

Where do the three children of The Traveling Trio travel in this video?

- **A.** To a ranch in Texas.
- **B.** To a mountain in California.
- **C.** To Cesky Krumlov, a fairy-tale town in the Czech Republic.
- **D.** To a forest in Italy.

Q10 RI.3.3

According to the video, why are there very few theaters like the old one the children visit?

- **A.** Because they were too small to use.
- **B.** Because many burned down, since theaters used candles to light the stage.
- **C.** Because no one wanted to build them.
- **D.** Because they were moved to other countries.

Q11 RI.3.3

What kinds of jobs did stagehands do at the old theater?

- **A.** They sold tickets at the front door.
- **B.** They acted out the main parts on stage.
- **C.** They painted pictures of the audience.
- **D.** They stayed under the stage and worked pulleys and levers to make things happen on the stage.

Q12 RI.3.3

How did the old theater make the sound of thunder during a show?

- **A.** Jagged wheels on a wooden device made a thunder sound as they moved back and forth.
- **B.** The actors shouted as loudly as they could.
- **C.** A drum was played in the audience.
- **D.** Real rain fell on the roof.

Q13 RI.3.3

How do actors appear or disappear from the stage in the old theater?

- **A.** They climb a tall ladder.
- **B.** They hide behind the audience.
- **C.** They turn off all the lights.
- **D.** They walk through trapdoors in the stage floor.

Q14 RI.3.3

Who narrates this informational video?

- ◯ **A.** A grown-up history teacher.
- ◯ **B.** The three children you see in the video, who are also its narrators.
- ◯ **C.** An actor dressed as a king.
- ◯ **D.** A stagehand under the stage.

Q15 RI.3.3 TRAP

How is an informational VIDEO different from a printed play like "The Saga of Pecos Bill"?

- ◯ **A.** A video can never share any true facts.
- ◯ **B.** A video must always be about animals.
- ◯ **C.** A video has no narrator at all.
- ◯ **D.** A video uses moving pictures, a narrator's voice, music, and sound effects to give information.

Q16 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "The Traveling Trio: Cesky Krumlov, Czech Republic"?

- ◯ **A.** An old theater used clever off-stage tools, like trapdoors, pulleys, and sound devices, to bring a play to life.
- ◯ **B.** Cesky Krumlov has the largest castle in the world.
- ◯ **C.** The Czech Republic is hard to travel to.
- ◯ **D.** Children should not visit old theaters.

Selection 3 · Gigi and the Wishing Ring

PLAY · CLASSIC TALE · ITALIAN FAIRY TALE / SUMI COLLINA · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.3.3

Why does Gigi leave home at the start of the play?

- ◯ **A.** Because his mother sends him away.
- ◯ **B.** Because there is no food at home.
- ◯ **C.** Because he wants to see the world and seek adventure and fortune.
- ◯ **D.** Because a lord orders him to leave.

Q18 RL.3.3

What warning does the Old Woman give Gigi about the wishing ring?

- ◯ **A.** Never to wear it at night.
- ◯ **B.** Never to make more than one wish.
- ◯ **C.** Never to give it to his mother.
- ◯ **D.** Never, ever to tell anyone about the ring.

Q19 RL.3.6

When Maliarda says to the audience, "If he is a lord, I am the Queen of England!", what does this tell the reader that Gigi does NOT know?

- ◯ **A.** That she does not believe he is a real lord and plans to deceive him.
- ◯ **B.** That she is truly a queen.
- ◯ **C.** That she wants to marry him.
- ◯ **D.** That she is leaving the forest.

Q20 RL.3.3

How does Maliarda trick Gigi and get the ring?

- ◯ **A.** She steals it while he is asleep.
- ◯ **B.** She buys it from the Old Woman.
- ◯ **C.** She begs to know his secret until he tells her, then puts on the ring and wishes him to the top of the highest mountain.
- ◯ **D.** She trades her own ring for it.

Q21 RL.3.3

How do Cat and Dog finally get the ring back from Maliarda?

- ◯ **A.** They knock down the door of the house.
- ◯ **B.** They send Mouse under the door to get the ring, and then Cat puts it on and wishes Gigi back.
- ◯ **C.** They ask the Old Woman for help.
- ◯ **D.** They climb the mountain to reach Gigi.

Q22 RL.3.5

In the script, the words "(To audience)" appear before some of Maliarda's lines. What do these stage directions tell the actor to do?

- ◯ **A.** Whisper the line to Gigi.
- ◯ **B.** Sing the line out loud.
- ◯ **C.** Speak the line to the people watching, so they hear her true thoughts but Gigi does not.
- ◯ **D.** Leave the stage right away.

Q23 RL.3.2

What lesson, or theme, does Gigi learn by the end of the play?

- ◯ **A.** Magic rings always bring good luck.
- ◯ **B.** You only get from people what you give to people.
- ◯ **C.** It is best to live alone.
- ◯ **D.** Fine clothes are the key to happiness.

Q24 RL.3.3 TRAP

Why do Cat and Dog help Gigi even after he ignores their warning about Maliarda?

- ◯ **A.** They want the ring for themselves.
- ◯ **B.** Maliarda pays them to help.
- ◯ **C.** They are afraid of the Old Woman.
- ◯ **D.** They are loyal friends who will do whatever it takes to save him.

Selection 4 · Two Bear Cubs

PLAY · MYTH · ROBERT D. SAN SOUCI / HELEN DARDIK · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.3.5

The play opens with a PROLOGUE spoken by the Storyteller. What does this prologue do?

- ◯ **A.** It tells the very last event of the play.
- ◯ **B.** It gives background and tells that the Miwok people share this story of the old days.
- ◯ **C.** It lists the props used in the play.
- ◯ **D.** It teaches the audience a song.

Q26 RL.3.3

Why do the two bear cubs end up high on top of a new mountain?

- ◯ **A.** Hawk carries them up in his claws.
- ◯ **B.** Their mother sends them up to hide.
- ◯ **C.** They climb up to pick berries.
- ◯ **D.** They fall asleep on a flat stone, and the stone grows bigger and higher into a mountain.

Q27 RL.3.3

Why can't Hawk rescue the sleeping cubs from the top of the mountain?

- ◯ **A.** The wind blows too hard for him to reach them.
- ◯ **B.** He cannot see them.
- ◯ **C.** He is too tired to fly.
- ◯ **D.** He does not want to help.

Q28 RL.3.3

How do the other animals react when tiny Measuring Worm says, "I will try"?

- ◯ **A.** They cheer and thank him at once.
- ◯ **B.** They tell him to stay home.
- ◯ **C.** They stare and laugh at him, and Mountain Lion calls him foolish.
- ◯ **D.** They climb up with him.

Q29 RL.3.3

How does Measuring Worm succeed in reaching the cubs when bigger animals failed?

- **A.** He waits for the wind to stop.
- **B.** He does not give up — he finds his courage and keeps climbing, stretching and curling, all the way to the top.
- **C.** He flies up like Hawk.
- **D.** He digs a tunnel inside the mountain.

Q30 RL.3.3

Why does Mother Grizzly scold the cubs even though she is happy they are safe?

- **A.** Because they ate all the fish.
- **B.** Because they were too slow coming down.
- **C.** Because they disobeyed her and went downriver, where she had warned them not to go.
- **D.** Because they laughed at Measuring Worm.

Q31 RL.3.2

According to the Storyteller, why is the great mountain named Tu-tok-a-nu-la?

- **A.** To honor Measuring Worm (Tu-tok-a-na), the heroic worm who saved the cubs; it means "Measuring Worm Stone."
- **B.** Because Mother Grizzly named it after herself.
- **C.** Because it was the tallest mountain in California.
- **D.** Because the cubs slept there.

Q32 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the THEME, or lesson about life, of "Two Bear Cubs"?

- **A.** Big animals are always the most useful.
- **B.** Berries are bad to eat.
- **C.** Mountains should never be climbed.
- **D.** You don't have to be big to do big things — and it is wise to listen to your elders.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 4 · Stories on Stage · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how a play can be an effective way to tell a story. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Form / Structure DOK 3

A play is built from special parts. In **"The Saga of Pecos Bill,"** show THREE parts of the play's FORM and what each one does for the reader.

THREE PARTS OF A PLAY · THE SAGA OF PECOS BILL

CAST OF CHARACTERS	STAGING NOTE	LINES OF DIALOGUE

Why does using FOUR narrators make this tall tale fun to listen to? Explain.

Q2 Communication DOK 3

In **"The Traveling Trio,"** an old theater uses off-stage tools to bring a play to life. Show THREE tools and what each one helps the audience see, hear, or believe.

STAGECRAFT · TOOLS THAT TELL THE STORY

Tools of the Stage

TRAPDOORS — WHAT DO THEY LET ACTORS DO?

PULLEYS & LEVERS — WHO WORKS THEM, AND WHY?

SOUND DEVICES — WHAT FEELING DO THEY CREATE?

BACKDROP — WHAT DOES IT SHOW THE AUDIENCE?

Why are these off-stage tools an effective way to tell a story? Explain.

Q3 Beliefs and Values DOK 3

In **"Gigi and the Wishing Ring,"** Gigi learns a life lesson the hard way. Trace THREE steps that lead him to the lesson "you only get from people what you give."

THREE STEPS · GIGI'S LIFE LESSON

STEP 1 · KINDNESS

how does Gigi treat the Old Woman, and what does she give him?

STEP 2 · THE LIE

what does Gigi do to Maliarda, and what does she do back?

STEP 3 · LOYALTY

how do Cat and Dog treat Gigi, and why?

In your own words, what does Gigi's lesson mean?

Q4 Culture / Tradition DOK 3

Each play comes from a different storytelling tradition. Compare HOW two plays from different cultures tell their stories on stage.

TWO CULTURES · TWO WAYS TO TELL A STORY

PECOS BILL · AMERICAN TALL TALE	TWO BEAR CUBS · MIWOK MYTH

What does each play try to "explain" about the world? (Hint: wide-open Texas / a mountain called El Capitan.)

Q5 Communication / Expression DOK 4

Essential Question: In what ways might a play be an effective way to tell a story? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What part of a play (narrator, dialogue, stage directions, staging) makes it effective?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What part of a play (narrator, dialogue, stage directions, staging) makes it effective?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 4 · Stories on Stage · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Class Play

Mr. Lee's class was going to put on a play. On Monday, everyone met to read the script. The script was a small book with all the words the actors would say. It also told the actors when to walk, sit, or stand. These notes were called stage directions. Maya wanted to be the lead. To get the part, she had to try out in front of the class. This is called an audition. Maya read her lines clearly and with feeling. Mr. Lee smiled and gave her the role. Now the real work began. Every day after school, the class would practice the play again and again. Maya learned that this is called rehearsal. At first the actors forgot their lines. But after many tries, they knew the play by heart. When the big night came, the actors were ready. The whole class clapped and cheered.

150 WORDS · LEXILE 410–460L · RIT 195–201

Q1 RIT 195 | Lexile 410L | Key Detail

What was Mr. Lee's class going to do?

- ◯ **A.** Build a new school.
- ◯ **B.** Go on a long trip.
- ◯ **C.** Put on a play.
- ◯ **D.** Write a book of poems.

Q2 RIT 197 | Lexile 420L | Key Detail

What did Maya have to do to get the lead role?

- ◯ **A.** Paint the set by herself.
- ◯ **B.** Pay Mr. Lee for the part.
- ◯ **C.** Sew all the costumes.
- ◯ **D.** Try out, or audition, in front of the class.

Q3 RIT 199 | Lexile 440L | Cause & Effect

Why did the actors know the play "by heart" by the big night?

- ◯ **A.** Because the play was very short.
- ◯ **B.** Because they practiced again and again at rehearsal.
- ◯ **C.** Because Mr. Lee told them the answers.
- ◯ **D.** Because they read it only one time.

Q4 RIT 200 · Lexile 450L · Vocabulary

In the passage, **stage directions** are —

- **A.** notes that tell the actors when to walk, sit, or stand.
- **B.** the names of the actors.
- **C.** the tickets people buy.
- **D.** the lights above the stage.

Q5 RIT 201 · Lexile 460L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Class Play"?

- **A.** Maya is the best actor in the world.
- **B.** Plays should only be done at night.
- **C.** Putting on a play takes trying out, learning a script, and a lot of practice.
- **D.** Reading is harder than acting.

Passage 2 · Shadow Puppets

Long before there were movies, people told stories with shadow puppets. A shadow puppet is a flat figure cut from leather or thick paper. Thin sticks are joined to the puppet so a person can move its arms and legs. To put on a show, the puppeteer sits behind a thin white screen. A bright lamp shines from behind the puppet. The light makes a dark shadow of the puppet fall onto the screen. The audience sits on the other side and watches the moving shadows. In some countries, shadow puppet shows are very old. They tell stories of brave heroes and clever animals. A storyteller often speaks for each puppet and plays music, too. Even though the puppets are flat and made of paper, they seem alive on the screen. With light, a screen, and a steady hand, a simple shadow can tell a whole story.

152 WORDS · LEXILE 470–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 · Lexile 470L · Key Detail

What is a shadow puppet made from?

- **A.** Soft cloth and yarn.
- **B.** A flat figure cut from leather or thick paper.
- **C.** Heavy stone and metal.
- **D.** Glass and water.

Q7 RIT 204 · Lexile 490L · Cause & Effect

What makes the dark shadow of the puppet fall onto the screen?

- **A.** The audience claps loudly.
- **B.** The puppet is painted black.
- **C.** The screen is made of glass.
- **D.** A bright lamp shines from behind the puppet.

Q8 RIT 205 · Lexile 500L · Inference

The passage says the flat paper puppets "seem alive on the screen." This MOST likely means the puppets —

- ◯ **A.** can really walk and talk.
- ◯ **B.** are turned into real animals.
- ◯ **C.** look like they are moving and acting, even though they are only paper.
- ◯ **D.** are too heavy to lift.

Q9 RIT 206 · Lexile 510L · Vocabulary

In the passage, the **puppeteer** is —

- ◯ **A.** the person who moves the puppet and puts on the show.
- ◯ **B.** the white screen.
- ◯ **C.** the bright lamp.
- ◯ **D.** a person in the audience.

Q10 RIT 207 · Lexile 530L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Shadow Puppets"?

- ◯ **A.** Movies are better than puppets.
- ◯ **B.** Leather is the strongest material.
- ◯ **C.** With light, a screen, and a steady hand, simple shadow puppets can tell a whole story.
- ◯ **D.** Music should always be loud.

Passage 3 · The Curtain Rises

Have you ever wondered what happens behind the big curtain at a theater? Before a show, the stage is a busy place. Workers called the stage crew get everything ready. They move the scenery into place. Scenery shows the audience where a scene happens, such as a forest or a castle. The crew also checks the lights. Some lights are bright and white. Others are colored to set a mood. A blue light can make a scene feel like night. The crew tests the sound, too. When all is ready, the lights in the audience grow dim. This tells everyone the show is about to start. Then the curtain rises, and the actors walk onto the stage. The audience grows quiet. For the next hour, paint and cloth and light will turn an empty stage into another world. That is the magic of the theater.

153 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 · Lexile 540L · Key Detail

Who gets everything ready before a show?

- ◯ **A.** The workers called the stage crew.
- ◯ **B.** The people in the audience.
- ◯ **C.** The ticket sellers.
- ◯ **D.** The main actor alone.

Q12 RIT 209 · Lexile 560L · Cause & Effect

Why do the lights in the audience grow dim before the curtain rises?

- ◯ **A.** To help the audience read their tickets.
- ◯ **B.** Because the building is closing.
- ◯ **C.** Because the lights are broken.
- ◯ **D.** To tell everyone the show is about to start.

Q13 RIT 210 · Lexile 570L · Inference

The passage says a blue light "can make a scene feel like night." This helps the reader understand that lights are used to —

- ◯ **A.** keep the actors warm.
- ◯ **B.** help set the mood or time of a scene.
- ◯ **C.** count the people in the seats.
- ◯ **D.** hide the actors from view.

Q14 RIT 211 · Lexile 580L · Vocabulary

In the passage, **scenery** is —

- ◯ **A.** something that shows the audience where a scene happens, like a forest or a castle.
- ◯ **B.** the sound the crew tests.
- ◯ **C.** a dim light in the audience.
- ◯ **D.** a row of seats near the stage.

Q15 RIT 212 · Lexile 600L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Curtain Rises"?

- ◯ **A.** Curtains are made of heavy cloth.
- ◯ **B.** Blue is the best color for lights.
- ◯ **C.** Actors should arrive early.
- ◯ **D.** A stage crew uses scenery, lights, and sound to turn an empty stage into another world.

Passage 4 · The Greek Theater

More than two thousand years ago, the people of ancient Greece loved to watch plays. They built theaters out of stone. The seats were carved into the side of a hill, curving around a flat space at the bottom. This is where the actors stood. The hill helped the audience see and hear the play. Because the seats rose up like steps, even people in the back row had a clear view. The shape also carried the actors' voices, so the words reached the top. There were no microphones back then. To help the crowd see their faces, actors wore large masks. A happy mask had a smile; a sad mask had a frown. One actor could play many parts just by changing masks. Some of these old stone theaters still stand today. People sometimes perform plays in them, just as the Greeks did long ago.

154 WORDS · LEXILE 610–680L · RIT 213–215

Q16 RIT 213 | Lexile 610L | Key Detail

What did the people of ancient Greece build their theaters out of?

- **A.** Stone.
- **B.** Glass.
- **C.** Cloth.
- **D.** Ice.

Q17 RIT 214 | Lexile 630L | Cause & Effect

Why could even people in the back row see the play clearly?

- **A.** Because they used telescopes.
- **B.** Because the actors were very tall.
- **C.** Because the seats rose up like steps on the side of a hill.
- **D.** Because the plays were short.

Q18 RIT 214 | Lexile 650L | Inference

Why did the actors wear large masks?

- **A.** To keep their faces warm.
- **B.** To help the crowd see their faces and show whether a character was happy or sad.
- **C.** To hide from the audience.
- **D.** Because masks were a kind of ticket.

Q19 RIT 215 | Lexile 670L | Vocabulary

The passage says one actor could play many parts "just by changing masks." Here, **parts** most nearly means —

- **A.** pieces of a broken object.
- **B.** sections of the stone seats.
- **C.** equal shares of food.
- **D.** different characters, or roles, in the play.

Q20 RIT 215 | Lexile 680L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Greek Theater"?

- **A.** Masks are scary to wear.
- **B.** The ancient Greeks built clever stone theaters whose shape and masks helped everyone see and hear the play.
- **C.** Greece has many hills.
- **D.** Old theaters should be torn down.